

DEREK WANG

Canadian Citizen | (416) 898-6127 | derek.wang1@uwaterloo.ca | in/4derekwang/ | github.com/4ppleSA0CE | 4pplesa0ce.github.io

Education

University of Waterloo

Waterloo, ON, Canada

Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering

Expected Apr 2030

- Relevant Coursework: Fundamentals of Programming, Linear Algebra for Engineering, Project Studio

Experience

Robotics Software Programmer – VEX Robotics Competition

Sept 2024 – May 2025

Checkmate Robotics Club

Markham, Ontario

- Programmed competition software for Team 16868C Rushdown in the VEX Robotics Competition, securing invitation to the 2025 VRC World Championships among top 10% of global teams
- Deployed advanced robotics systems using Okapi PROS Library, Odometry positioning, and PID Controllers, boosting robot performance by 25% through precise motion control and comprehensive error handling
- Designed and refactored autonomous navigation algorithms, creating 15-second match routes and 60-second programming skills routines that achieved 5th place out of 80 teams at Provincial Championships

Youth Badminton Instructor

Mar 2024 – Aug 2025

City of Richmond Hill

Richmond Hill, Ontario

- Evaluated student skill levels and formulated personalized coaching strategies for 14 beginner to intermediate students (ages 9–16), yielding 85% improvement in technique scores and game performance across 8-week terms
- Pioneered comprehensive badminton curriculum focused on real game situations, achieving 100% adoption across all badminton classes at 2 community centers (Rouge Woods and Richvale), enhancing student engagement by 40%
- Built individual mentorship programs through personalized feedback delivery, optimizing lesson plans to address specific performance gaps and foster an inclusive learning environment

Robot Designer and Builder – FIRST Tech Challenge

July 2019 – May 2022

Dr. X Robotics Academy

Richmond Hill, Ontario

- Architected hardware solutions for Team 16417 Dr. X Academy in the FIRST Tech Challenge, earning invitation to the 2022 FTC World Championships among top 8% of global teams
- Designed and built 8 iterations of the team's robot, developing specialized components including drivetrain, arm, claw, turret systems and a backup robot for competition reliability
- Implemented autonomous control systems using Java, creating 30-second match routines with Dead Reckoning position estimation for precise navigation

Projects

Autonomous Vehicle Control System | C++ | Docker | CMake | Foxglove | [Source Code](#) | [Demo Video](#)

Sept 2025

- Engineered LiDAR-based perception pipeline processing sensor data to generate real-time costmaps with 0.1m resolution, integrating persistent memory mapping system for 95% accurate dynamic environment representation
- Orchestrated autonomous navigation stack featuring A* path planning algorithm and Pure Pursuit tracking algorithm, achieving sub-0.5m waypoint accuracy and 100% obstacle avoidance success rate across 50+ test scenarios

Fruit Ninja AI | Python | YOLOv11 | [Source Code](#)

Aug 2025 – Sept 2025

- Architected and implemented an automated computer vision pipeline using YOLOv11 object detection, achieving 90% accuracy in fruit classification
- Built comprehensive dataset of 816 images (514 training, 302 testing), optimizing model performance through strategic data augmentation and validation techniques

TTC Escape Puzzle Game | C# | Unity | Git | [Source Code](#)

July 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed innovative puzzle game concept for the 2025 GMTK Game Jam, leading a team of 3 developers
- Developed and implemented core gameplay mechanics using Unity and C#, creating a Toronto Transit Commission-inspired puzzle game featuring looping mechanics that enhanced player engagement

Skills

Languages: Java, C++, Python, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, C#, TypeScript

Engineering Tools: Git, Fusion 360, Unity, Docker, Foxglove

Technologies: ReactJS, OpenCV, YOLOv11, Tailwind CSS